COST Intelligence Report

Report as_of: **2026-10-24** | Market data as_of: **2026-10-23** | Market data fetched (UTC): **2026-10-25T00:59:35.760376+00:00**

Costco Wholesale Corporation | Consumer Defensive / Discount Stores

AI status: **Available** | Configured model: **openai/gpt-oss-20b** | News snapshot: **2026-10-24**

Report rendering uses saved source snapshots with separate observation dates. The daily price bar may be provisional before the listing market closes. Check source dates and availability.

News (report-date window: previous 7 days plus report date): **22** unique headlines; **22** classified or explicitly excluded; **0** still unclassified. Named publishers: **10**. Latest RSS publication: **2026-10-24**.

Quantitative

Metric	Value
Close	1003.3200
Return 1D (%)	-1.4624
Return 1W (%)	1.4366
Return 1M (%)	10.9009
Return YTD (%)	16.8621
Return 1Y (%)	7.1253
Annualized volatility (%)	19.7998
Beta vs SPY	-0.1841
Max drawdown (%)	-18.1993
Sharpe (rf=0)	0.4477
Downside deviation (rf=0, %)	13.7252
Sortino (rf=0)	0.6459
Historical VaR 95% (1D, %)	2.0766
Historical ES 95% (1D, %)	2.7374
Correlation vs SPY	-0.1185
Tracking error vs SPY (%)	24.7857
P/E (trailing)	48.33
P/B	12.42
EV/EBITDA	30.56
Revenue growth (%)	11.10
Forward P/E (estimate)	40.09
Gross margin (%)	12.77
Operating margin (%)	3.79
Return on equity (%)	28.40
Free cash flow yield (%)	1.52
MA50	938.8648
Close vs MA50 (%)	6.8652
MA200	967.6397
Close vs MA200 (%)	3.6874
RSI (14, Wilder)	69.1972
MACD (12,26)	22.1491
MACD signal (9)	16.0507
MACD histogram	6.0984

Methodology: adjusted daily closes (yfinance auto_adjust=True; Stooq fallback if unavailable). 1Y return uses the last trading day on or before the one-year boundary. Risk metrics use historical returns and are not forecasts; asset and

SPY returns are not FX-adjusted in cross-listing comparisons. Free cash flow yield is unavailable unless vendor financial and listing currencies match. See unavailable values as N/A.

HOW TO READ THE QUANTITATIVE SECTION

These rule-based bands are judgment choices for this research report, not investment advice.

- **Close**: The latest adjusted closing price is measured in the quoted currency. This value: 1003.3200 -> Price level only; it does not by itself indicate valuation.
- **Return 1D (%)**: The adjusted closing price change over one trading day is measured as a percentage. This value: -1.4624 -> Adjusted price fell over this period.
- **Return 1W (%)**: The adjusted closing price change over one week is measured as a percentage. This value: 1.4366 -> Adjusted price rose over this period.
- **Return 1M (%)**: The adjusted closing price change over one month is measured as a percentage. This value: 10.9009 -> Adjusted price rose over this period.
- **Return YTD (%)**: The adjusted closing price change over the year to date is measured as a percentage. This value: 16.8621 -> Adjusted price rose over this period.
- **Return 1Y (%)**: The adjusted closing price change over one year is measured as a percentage. This value: 7.1253 -> Adjusted price rose over this period.
- **Annualized volatility (%)**: The variability of daily returns is scaled to one year as a percentage. This value: 19.7998 -> Low annualized volatility.
- **Downside deviation (rf=0, %)**: Root-mean-square downside daily return below zero, annualized with 252 trading days; historical, not predictive. This value: 13.7252 -> No interpretation rule is available for this metric.
- **Sortino (rf=0)**: Mean daily return divided by zero-target downside deviation, scaled by sqrt(252); undefined when downside deviation is zero. This value: 0.6459 -> No interpretation rule is available for this metric.
- **Historical VaR 95% (1D, %)**: Observed daily loss at the empirical fifth-percentile return, floored at zero; not a maximum loss. This value: 2.0766 -> No interpretation rule is available for this metric.
- **Historical ES 95% (1D, %)**: Average observed loss in returns at or below the empirical fifth percentile, floored at zero. This value: 2.7374 -> No interpretation rule is available for this metric.
- **Correlation vs SPY**: Pearson correlation of date-aligned daily asset/SPY returns in the sample; native-currency returns are not converted. This value: -0.1185 -> No interpretation rule is available for this metric.
- **Tracking error vs SPY (%)**: Annualized sample standard deviation of date-aligned daily asset-minus-SPY returns, in percentage points. This value: 24.7857 -> No interpretation rule is available for this metric.
- **Beta vs SPY**: Beta estimates how sensitively returns move with the SPY market benchmark. This value: -0.1841 -> Inverse market sensitivity.
- **Max drawdown (%)**: The largest peak-to-trough price decline in the sampled history is measured as a percentage. This value: -18.1993 -> Moderate peak-to-trough loss magnitude.
- **Sharpe (rf=0)**: Sharpe measures annualized return per unit of volatility using a zero risk-free rate. This value: 0.4477 -> Modest risk-adjusted return.
- **Forward P/E (estimate)**: Vendor estimate of price relative to expected future earnings; estimates can change. This value: 40.0906 -> No interpretation rule is available for this metric.
- **Gross margin (%)**: Gross profit divided by revenue, using the vendor-provided ratio; periods may differ. This value: 12.7660 -> No interpretation rule is available for this metric.

- **Operating margin (%)**: Operating income divided by revenue, using the vendor-provided ratio. This value: 3.7890 -> No interpretation rule is available for this metric.
- **Return on equity (%)**: Vendor-reported profit relative to shareholder equity; leverage can affect the ratio. This value: 28.4020 -> Adjusted price rose over this period.
- **Free cash flow yield (%)**: Free cash flow divided by market capitalization, only when both reported currencies match. This value: 1.5188 -> No interpretation rule is available for this metric.
- **P/E (trailing)**: The share price is divided by trailing earnings per share. This value: 48.3295 -> High trailing earnings multiple under the research bands.
- **RSI (14, Wilder)**: The 14-period relative strength index compares recent gains with losses on a 0 to 100 scale. This value: 69.1972 -> Neutral momentum reading.
- **MACD histogram**: The difference between MACD and its signal line measures their momentum gap in price units. This value: 6.0984 -> Positive momentum relative to the MACD signal line.
- **Close vs MA50 (%)**: The closing price distance from its 50-day moving average is measured as a percentage. This value: 6.8652 -> Clearly above the moving-average trend level.
- **Close vs MA200 (%)**: The closing price distance from its 200-day moving average is measured as a percentage. This value: 3.6874 -> Slightly above the moving-average trend level.

Tailwinds

1. Costco (COST) Stock May Be Priced For Perfection On Earnings

Analyst suggests Costco’s stock may be optimally priced ahead of earnings, indicating positive market sentiment.

Date: **2026-10-23** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.8**

Sources: Simply Wall Street

2. The Zacks Analyst Blog Highlights Costco, Walt Disney, Marriott, Park Aerospace and Flanigan's

Zacks blog spotlights Costco among top picks, implying favorable analyst coverage.

Date: **2026-10-19** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.7**

Sources: Yahoo Finance

3. Costco Wholesale Corporation $COST Stock: Adams Diversified Equity Fund Inc. Grows Position

Adams Diversified Equity Fund increased its stake in Costco, signaling institutional confidence.

Date: **2026-10-24** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.8**

Sources: MarketBeat

Headwinds

1. Truist reiterates Hold on Costco stock citing strong comps

Truist maintains a hold rating, suggesting cautious outlook despite strong comparable companies.

Date: **2026-10-19** | Impact: **low** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.6**

Sources: Investing.com

2. Costco Wholesale Corporation $COST Holdings Trimmed by Sepio Capital LP

Sepio Capital LP reduced its holdings in Costco, indicating potential negative sentiment.

Date: **2026-10-24** | Impact: **low** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.7**

Sources: MarketBeat

Catalysts

1. Costco's Last Stock Split Was in 2000. Is Its Board Close to Another?

Date: **2026-10-22** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.8**

Sources: Yahoo Finance [1], Yahoo Finance [2]

2. Costco Turned $1,000 Into $8,018 in Ten Years While the S&P 500 Delivered $3,564

Date: **2026-10-22** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.8**

Sources: 24/7 Wall St.

3. Costco Wholesale Corporation $COST Stock Acquired by Howland Capital Management LLC

Date: **2026-10-24** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.8**

Sources: MarketBeat

4. Costco Is Paying a Dividend Next Month. Here’s the Deadline to Buy the Stock

Date: **2026-10-21** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.8**

Sources: South Florida Reporter

5. Costco (COST) Advances While Market Declines: Some Information for Investors

Costco shares rise amid broader market decline, signaling investor confidence.

Date: **2026-10-22** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.8**

Sources: Yahoo Finance

6. Costco Wholesale (NASDAQ:COST) Stock Falls 1.5% - Should You Sell?

Stock price dropped 1.5%, prompting sell■side speculation.

Date: **2026-10-23** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.8**

Sources: MarketBeat

7. Is Costco Wholesale (NASDAQ:COST) Standing Strong Amid Market Rotation?

Analysis of Costco’s resilience during sector rotation.

Date: **2026-10-24** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.7**

Sources: Kalkine Media

8. Costco Wholesale Corporation $COST Stock Holdings Reduced by Hosking Partners LLP

Hosking Partners LLP decreased its Costco holdings.

Date: **2026-10-23** | Impact: **low** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.7**

Sources: MarketBeat

Risks

No qualified events assigned to this category among 22 sampled headlines; this does not prove no events occurred.

Peer Comparables

Ticker	P/E	P/B	EV/EBITDA	Rev growth (%)	Mkt cap (local)	1Y ret (%)
COST	**48.33**	**12.42**	**30.56**	**11.10**	**444.60B USD**	**7.13**
WMT	43.44	9.69	23.17	5.90	954.09B USD	13.14
TGT	15.86	3.89	9.68	5.30	69.40B USD	68.64
BJ	22.24	6.09	13.88	15.70	13.37B USD	13.23

Peers fetched as_of: 2026-10-24; COST reuses existing data. Fundamentals are yfinance info snapshots; missing values are not interpolated.

Earnings Calendar

Last reported earnings: **2026-09-24**
Next expected earnings: **2026-12-10** (yfinance; expected dates may change)

Macro (FRED)

Metric	Series	Latest value	Obs. date
Unemployment rate (%)	UNRATE	4.200	2026-09-01
Consumer Price Index (1982–1984=100)	CPIAUCSL	336.298	2026-09-01
Federal funds rate (%)	FEDFUNDS	3.750	2026-09-01
ISM Manufacturing PMI	NAPM	N/A	N/A

Fetched as_of: 2026-10-24

Latest Filing (EDGAR)

Form: **10-K** | Filing date: **2026-10-07**
Revenue (latest quarter): 69,597,000,000.00 USD; period 2025-11-24/2026-02-15; fiscal 2026/Q2
Net income (latest quarter): 2,192,000,000.00 USD; period 2026-02-16/2026-05-10; fiscal 2026/Q3
SEC filing: Open on SEC EDGAR

SEC requests use the configured organization and contact identity. Financial values use directly reported periods of approximately three months, without deriving quarters from cumulative values.

Sources

- [1] Simply Wall Street (news.google.com)
- [2] Yahoo Finance (news.google.com)
- [3] MarketBeat (news.google.com)
- [4] Investing.com (news.google.com)
- [5] MarketBeat (news.google.com)
- [6] Yahoo Finance (news.google.com)
- [7] Yahoo Finance (news.google.com)
- [8] 24/7 Wall St. (news.google.com)
- [9] MarketBeat (news.google.com)
- [10] South Florida Reporter (news.google.com)

- [11] Yahoo Finance (news.google.com)
- [12] MarketBeat (news.google.com)
- [13] Kalkine Media (news.google.com)
- [14] MarketBeat (news.google.com)

API documentation: SEC EDGAR APIs | FRED observations

Research notes and limitations

Daily multi-source research; AI items require human spot checks; RSS coverage is not guaranteed. Missing market data or fundamentals are marked N/A; no numbers are fabricated.

This report is not investment advice.